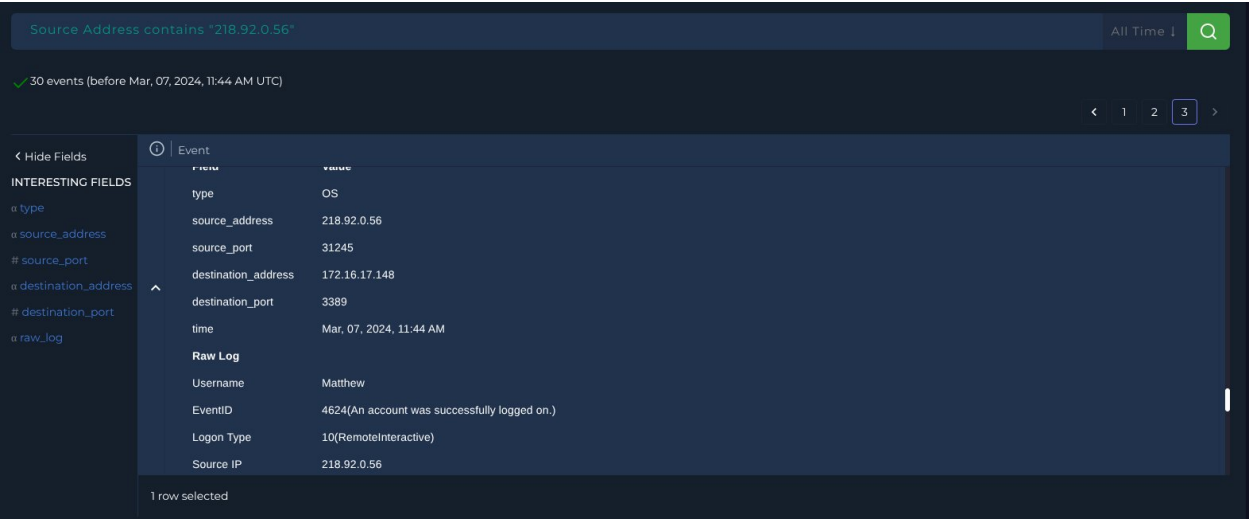


Event Information:

EventID :
234
Event Time :
Mar, 07, 2024, 11:44 AM
Rule :
SOC176 - RDP Brute Force Detected
Level :
Security Analyst
Source IP Address :
218.92.0.56
Destination IP Address :
172.16.17.148
Destination Hostname :
Matthew
Protocol :
RDP
Firewall Action :
Allowed
Alert Trigger Reason :
Login failure from a single source with different non existing accounts

Analysis Steps:

Logs were searched with IP 218[.]92.0.56 as the source in the relevant time-frame yielding 30 events. The attacker can be seen attempting an RPD brute force on the 172.16.17.148 (Matthew) endpoint.



We can observe that one of these was successful with an EventID of 4624(An account was successfully logged on). Indicating account compromise.

The offending IP is listed as malicious in our CTI database/

DATE	DATA TYPE	DATA	TAG	DATA SOURCE
Mar, 08, 2024, 02:33 PM	IP	218.92.0.56	Malicious	Anonymous

The IP is external to the organisation. No emails have been received indicating penetration testing involving the IP for the relevant time period. VirusTotal indicates it is a Chinese address associated with 218.[.92.0.56 AS 4134 (Chinanet). 8/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious.

8 / 91
Community Score

6/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious

218.92.0.56 (218.92.0.0/16)
AS 4134 (Chinanet)

Reanalyze More

3 days ago

DETECTIONDETAILSRELATIONSCOMMUNITY

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Crowdsourced context

HIGH 0MEDIUM 0LOW 1INFO 1SUCCESS 0

SSH brute-force Attackers (2023-09-20) - according to source ArcSight Threat Intelligence - 2 years ago

Source: alienVault VirusTotal Link: https://www.virustotal.com/gui/ip-address/218.92.0.56/detection Abuse IPDB Link: https://www.abuseipdb.com/check/218.92.0.56

Find more information on CrowdSec CTI - according to source CrowdSec - 2 years ago

Behaviors: SSH Brute-force

Security vendors' analysis

alphaMountain.ai	Malicious	BitDefender	Phishing
Chong Lua Dao	Malicious	CyRadard	Phishing
Fortinet	Malware	G Data	Phishing
Lionic	Malicious	Webroot	Malicious

On AbuseIPDB this IP was reported 453,051 (wow!) times with a 0% confidence of abuse.

218.92.0.56 was found in our database!

This IP was reported 453,051 times. Confidence of Abuse is 0%: ?

0%

ISP

CHINANET jiangsu province network

Usage Type

Fixed Line ISP

ASN

AS4134

Domain Name

chinatelecom.cn

Country

 China

City

Shanghai, Shanghai

Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a successful True Positive.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a successful True Positive RDP brute-force attack targeting the endpoint Matthew (172[.]16.17.148). An external threat actor executed multiple login attempts and successfully compromised the user account via Remote Desktop Protocol.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC176 - RDP Brute Force Detected
- **Target Host:** Matthew (172[.]16.17.148)
- **Attacker IP:** 218[.]92.0.56
- **Device Action:** Allowed

Analysis and Evidence

- **Attack Execution:** Log Management reveals 30 events associated with the external IP attempting to connect to the host via port 3389 (RDP). The attacker systematically attempted to log in using different, non-existent accounts.
- **Success Confirmation:** At 11:44 AM, an OS log recorded an EventID 4624 (An account was successfully logged on) with the Logon Type 10 (RemoteInteractive). This confirms the attacker successfully brute-forced the credentials for the username Matthew.

Threat Intelligence

- **OSINT (Infrastructure):** The attacking IP (218[.]92.0.56) is external and resolves to Chinanet (AS 4134) in Shanghai, China.
- **Reputation:** The IP is explicitly tagged as malicious in the internal CTI database. VirusTotal flags the IP with 8/91 vendor detections, specifically noting SSH/brute-force behaviours. AbuseIPDB shows 453,051 reports for this address, highlighting an extensive history of automated scanning and brute-forcing.
- **Internal Correlation:** No internal communications indicate authorised penetration testing involving this IP during the relevant time-frame.

Actions Taken

1. Analysed OS and network logs to identify the 30 RDP authentication attempts originating from the external IP.
2. Verified the successful compromise of the Matthew account by correlating the Event ID 4624 logon success.
3. Investigated the attacker infrastructure via OSINT (VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB), confirming the IP is associated with known brute-force threat activity originating from China.
4. Isolated the affected endpoint (172[.]16.17.148) from the corporate network to prevent lateral movement.
5. Declared the alert a True Positive and escalated.

Let's Defend Result

SOC176 - RDP Brute Force Detected

True Positive (+5 Point)

Should the device be isolated? (+5 Point)

Log Management (+5 Point)

Determine the Scope (+5 Point)

Traffic Analysis (+5 Point)

IP Reputation Check (+5 Point)

Enrichment & Context (+5 Point)